



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Peter sends a company e-mail.



Learning Outcome

Describe common activities at work to a visitor using short sentences.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you write e-mails at work?
- What are the e-mails usually about?

Can Do Statements

- I can write a work e-mail.
- I can write about work routine.
- I can ask for and make suggestions in written form.





Let's Explore!

Peter e-mails his boss about time off. Do you think his boss will agree?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Amanda, I have a bit of a problem. I need some suggestions.
- Amanda:** What's wrong?
- Peter:** Well ... my sister is getting married this weekend.
- Amanda:** That's great!
- Peter:** The wedding is in Utah, and I just realized there are no flights on Saturday morning.
- Amanda:** Oh dear. Does that mean that you have to leave on Friday and miss work? We have our weekly meeting, and the market analysis for Monster Jam is due.
- Peter:** I know. I sent an e-mail to Mr. Warren.
- Amanda:** You could tell him that you finished your work. I can have your folders on the Outreach Program.
- Peter:** That's true. Thanks!
- Amanda:** What about sounding shocked and surprised in the e-mail? It might help.
- Peter:** Yeah, I might also suggest that I can work overtime on Monday as well.
- Amanda:** Good idea and good luck!





Let's Practice!

What should John include in his e-mail to Mr. Warren?

Instructions: Listen to the audio. Type in the missing words. Use a capital letter at the start of a sentence. Choose from the word bank below.

Word Bank

work / overtime / surprised / finished / your / work / the folder

1. You could tell him that you're _____ .
2. We have _____ on the Outreach Program.
3. What about sounding shocked and _____ in the e-mail?
4. I might also suggest that I can _____ on Monday.



Let's Practice!

Can you write a work e-mail?

Instructions: Choose all the correct answers.

1. What do you include in a company e-mail?
 - a. Subject line
 - b. Informal language
 - c. Greeting
 - d. Closing
 - e. Name





Extension Activity

Imagine you are Amanda. You have to write a work e-mail to Mr. Warren. You have to take two days off work.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a work e-mail to Mr. Warren.
- Include a subject line, greeting and closing.
- Use formal language.
- Read your e-mail to a partner or family member.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write a work e-mail to Mr. Warren.

☐ ☐

I use formal language in the e-mail.

☐ ☐

I proofread the e-mail.

☐ ☐

I read the e-mail to a partner or family member.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to attend** (verb): to go to and be present at
e.g. I need to attend the meeting.
- **to request** (verb): to politely or formally ask for something
e.g. I would like to request time off.
- **out of town** (expression): away from where you live for a period of time
e.g. I have to go out of town this weekend.
- **to assure** (verb): to make something certain
e.g. I assure that my work is done.
- **prior** (expression): existing earlier in time
e.g. The flight attendant completed the safety check prior to departure.
- **folder** (noun): a folded cover for holding documents
Example: The folder contains all the drafts.
- **notice** (noun): information that warns you about something that is going to happen
Example: I know this is short notice.
- **a lack of** (expression): not enough
Example: There is a lack of direct flights.
- **to present** (verb): to describe or show
e.g. I hope this doesn't present a problem.
- **audit** (noun): a careful look at financial records
Example: I plan to stay back and help with the audit.





Learning Points

Asking and Making Suggestions

When you make a suggestion, you give a possible course of action. There are a number of expressions you can use to make suggestions.

Suggestion	Example
How about/what about + -ing?	What about opening your gift now?
How about + present simple?	How about I pick out a nice suit for your wedding?
Why not ...?	Why not take the last flight on Friday night?
Let's ... and let's not ...	Let's call Peter and see if he knows where the report is.
Could	We could meet you at the airport before your flight.

Writing A Work E-mail

When you write a formal e-mail, include:

- a subject line stating the main purpose of the e-mail
- the important information first
- simple grammar
- short sentences
- separate paragraphs that are clear and simple

